LEAN CANVAS: MindPulse AI

AI-Powered Youth Mental Health Screening & First-line Supportive Companion

Program: IBM SkillsBuild Masterclass 5 • **Alignment:** UN SDG 3 (Target 3.4)
Focus: Youth in Tier-2/3 Cities & Students • **Version:** 1.0 (MVP Complete)

1. PROBLEM

Top 1-3 core problems faced by users

• **Acute Stigma & Shame:** 75%+ youth avoid on-campus physical counseling out of fear of judgment and social labeling.
• **Severe Shortage:** <1 licensed clinician per 100,000 citizens in semi-urban areas; therapy (Rs.1,500-4,000/hr) is cost-prohibitive for students.
• **Delayed Detection:** Students normalize distress as exam pressure until it leads to acute functional breakdown.

Existing Alternatives: Unmoderated forums (Reddit/Discord), paywalled apps (Calm/Headspace - $70/yr), late crisis helplines.

4. SOLUTION

Top 3 core features addressing problems

• **Aura AI Wellness Companion:** 24/7 empathetic listener trained in CBT cognitive reframing.
• **Clinical Screeners:** Validated PHQ-9 & GAD-7 tests with instant risk score and self-care steps.
• **Neuro-Somatic Zone:** Guided 4-7-8 breathing & 5-4-3-2-1 grounding to downregulate panic.
• **Crisis Triage:** Automated routing to free 24/7 national helplines (Tele-MANAS 14416 / KIRAN).

8. KEY METRICS

Key activities indicating traction

• **Engagement:** Daily Active Users (DAU) & 14-day retention rate.
• **Screenings:** Volume of completed PHQ-9 & GAD-7 assessments.
• **Somatic Calming:** Self-reported anxiety reduction score post-breathing.
• **Crisis Safeguard:** Number of high-risk cases safely connected to emergency hotlines.

3. UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION

Single clear, compelling message

"Instant, zero-cost, stigma-free mental health first-aid in your pocket — bridging the gap between silent personal struggle and professional care."

High-Level Concept:
"Duolingo meets Crisis Text Line for mental wellness and early triage."

Privacy Guarantee: Zero mandatory logins, 100% on-device local storage processing.

9. UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

Cannot easily be bought or copied

• **Clinical Instrument Integration:** Standardized diagnostic scoring algorithms (validated PHQ-9 & GAD-7) paired with local crisis triage rules.
• **Zero-Friction Offline Architecture:** Runs directly inside standard mobile/desktop browsers without paid LLM API dependency or app store barriers.

5. CHANNELS

Paths to reach target audience

• University student wellness cells & student unions.
• High-school stress seminars & academic portals.
• IBM SkillsBuild student ecosystem & youth NGO network.
• Social media mental hygiene awareness campaigns.

2. CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

Target customers and users

• **Primary:** High-school, college & university students (15-25) dealing with exam anxiety, loneliness, or depression.
• **Secondary:** Young job-seekers and early corporate professionals in Tier-2/3 cities facing burnout.
• **Institutional:** Colleges seeking scalable first-line wellness screening tools.

Early Adopters: Undergraduate STEM students facing heavy workload and competitive exam aspirants.

7. COST STRUCTURE

Fixed and variable infrastructure expenses

• **Fixed Costs:** Lightweight CDN web hosting & domain registration ($10-$25/year); advisory clinical review honorariums.
• **Variable Costs:** Natural language processing compute scaling; campus outreach collateral; security & privacy audit certifications.

6. REVENUE STREAMS

Financial sustainability & monetization models

• **B2B Institutional Licensing:** Annual subscriptions for universities & colleges for customized campus wellness portals and anonymized student stress index.
• **Corporate EAP Integration:** Licensing to early-career employee assistance programs.
• **Impact Grants & CSR:** CSR health funding (IBM SkillsBuild / public health foundations).